

BenQ EW270Q Gaming Monitor

2K resolution at 200Hz under ₹20,000

BenQ's recent monitors have leaned into a clean white aesthetic across several models. The BenQ EW270Q, a gaming monitor, also share this design. No RGB strips or aggressive branding. Rather, its appearance feels more at home in a work-from-home setup than a gamer's or streamer's room. For an asking price of Rs 17,989 in India, the BenQ monitor offers a 200Hz refresh rate, 2K resolution, 5Wx 2 speaker setup, and a USB-C port with up to 65W power delivery. On paper, this combination looks quite ambitious.

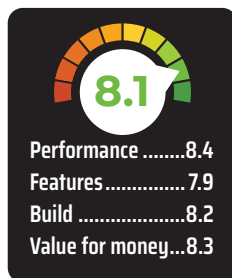
So, while using the EW270Q as a daily work monitor, a gaming display in the evenings, and a casual screen for movies and shows after hours, I aimed to test how it all actually holds up in real use.

CLEAN DESIGN

The white finish on the stand and rear panel immediately sets the BenQ EW270Q gaming monitor apart. It looks nice on a light-coloured desk. I use it alongside my M1 MacBook Air, and it blends well with the grey tone of the Mac. Someone buying a sub-Rs 20,000 monitor may be a student, freelancer or a professional working from home, and they may like this look.

The stand and the screen come detached in the box. But joining them is very easy. You can follow BenQ's tutorial on YouTube. Once set up on the desk, you can change its position by tilting and swiveling. So, ergonomic: check. The build quality is solid, too. BenQ

₹20,900



has used strong plastic with a clean finish. The stand doesn't wobble. The base is wide and stable, and it offers an enclosure to place small items like a phone, TWS case, god idols or soft toys. Thoughtful design choice.

The bezels are negligible. You shouldn't have a problem using it in a dual-monitor setup.

You can turn on the monitor with a physical joystick button on the back. This, along with two other buttons are situated on the back of the right side of the display. With these three buttons, you can navigate the menu, change picture modes and select input options.

The monitor supports accessing these menus and controls through BenQ's Display Pilot 2 app.

Besides the buttons, the ports are also present on the back. There is a power socket, a DisplayPort (1.4), an HDMI (2.0) port, a USB-C port, and a 3.5mm audio jack for headphones and

external speakers. The HDMI and DP are inputs for desktops and consoles.

The highlight is the USB-C with up to 65W power delivery. For MacBook and Windows laptop users, this acts as one cable for handling display output and charging the laptop. The one cable solution reduces desk clutter. During work hours, I had the monitor connected to my MacBook with a single USB-C cable, and everything just worked. The input detection is rather quick.

GAMING

The BenQ EW270Q uses a 27-inch QHD (2560 x 1440) panel with a 200Hz refresh rate. In the sub-Rs 20,000 segment, most high-refresh monitors still top out at FHD, or offer QHD at lower refresh rates.

During testing, I mostly used the EW270Q with a Sony PlayStation 5, which naturally caps refresh rate output depending on resolution. That meant I spent most of my time between 1080p 120Hz multiplayer sessions and 1440p 60Hz story-driven titles. While playing Ghost of Yotei, we had to tweak some settings and then were able to have clean motion and decent colours without noticeable lag. Gran Turismo 7 (GT7) also ran well.

The monitor's 200Hz refresh rate, AMD FreeSync Premium support, and 1ms GtG response times can be utilised on a powerful PC, though.

I had set AMA to High. AMA premium resulted in bright halos around moving objects. The monitor is HDR10 compliant with a 1200:1 native contrast ratio. It offers 3 HDR profiles. I chose the vibrant Game HDRi mode, which is punchier than 'HDR' and 'Standard' modes. But, when it comes to the brightness test, the HDR mode turned out to be the best result of about 360 nits in a 25% window. With a matte finish on top, it seemed fine for gaming indoors.

In the Calman test, we got close to 95% UHDA P3 coverage (HDR) and